

The Advocate Circuit

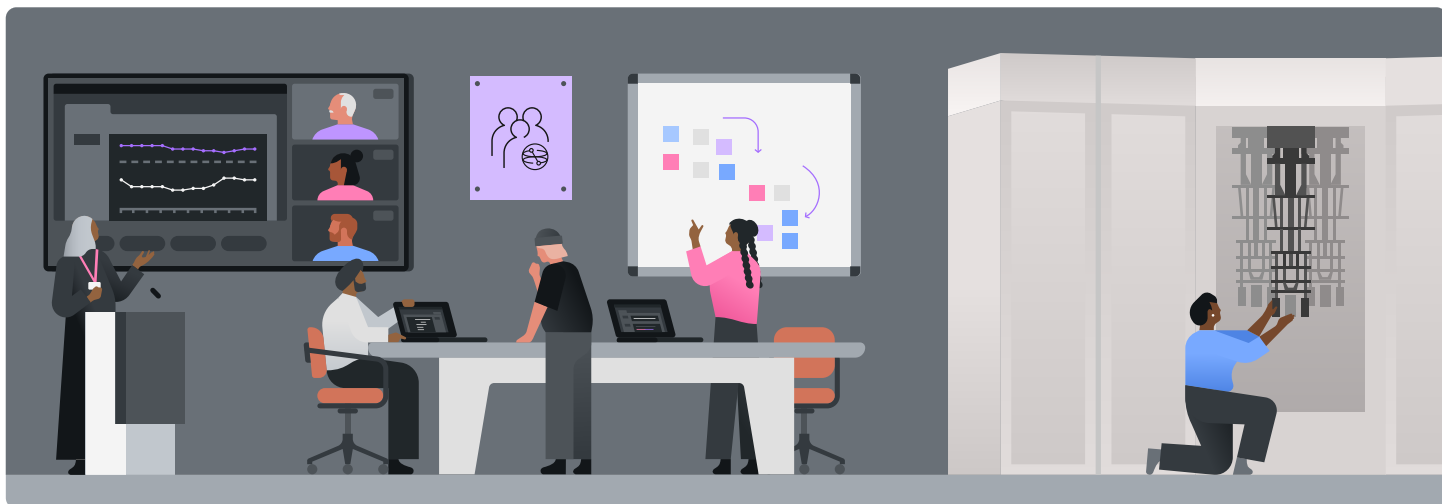
June 2026

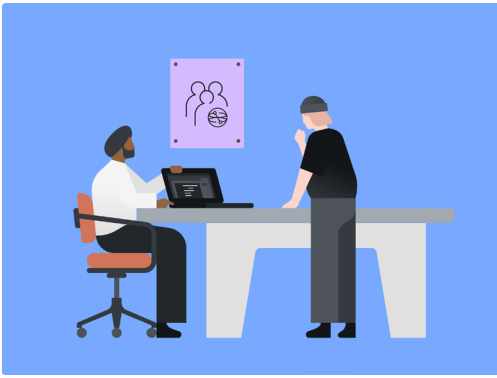
What's New?

Welcome to The Advocate Circuit, your go-to source for the latest updates, announcements, and opportunities in the Qiskit advocate program and Qiskit community!

In this newsletter, we will be updating you on this year's Qiskit Global Summer School and Qiskit Fall Fest and how you can get involved in each, the Qiskit Advocate study group initiative that has just wrapped up, IBM Think 2026, and highlight some of the recent releases and updates from Qiskit and IBM Quantum.

Let's dive in!





Qiskit Global Summer School 2026

Registration is now open for [Qiskit Global Summer School 2026](#): A decade on the cloud—the latest entry in an annual, global program designed to help students, researchers, and developers build practical skills in quantum computing. The two-week event will run from 13–24 July 2026.

It's been ten years since IBM put the first quantum computer on the cloud, giving rise to [a global ecosystem of developers, researchers, startups, and enterprises](#) all working to advance quantum technology. For this year's Qiskit Global Summer School (QGSS), we'll be celebrating that legacy while giving participants the skills to explore complex workloads on today's high-performance quantum computers.

If you are a beginner in quantum programming, or you are looking to upskill yourself, you are invited to participate in QGSS. [Register for Qiskit Global Summer School 2026](#).

This year, Qiskit advocates are also invited to participate in QGSS Development Week, happening June 8-12, 2026. Development Week is a dedicated pre-QGSS week focused on collaboration, lab testing, and preparation for a mentorship. Registration for Development Week is now closed.

We look forward to seeing you in either or both events!

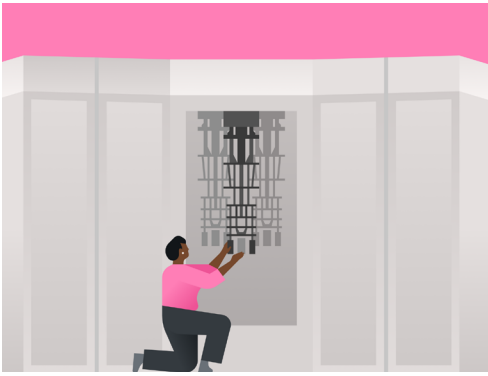
Qiskit Fall Fest 2026

Qiskit Fall Fest is returning for its sixth annual installment to once again bring the quantum community together for a global celebration of quantum technology, research, and collaboration!

Qiskit Fall Fest is a collection of quantum computing events that allows students, researchers and industry professionals to participate in various quantum-themed activities — including quantum challenges, hackathons, coding competitions, workshops, social events, and more. Each year, IBM partners with a select group of university students and other volunteer hosts to help them plan and run the global roster of Fall Fest events.

The theme for Qiskit Fall Fest 2026 celebrates a decade of quantum on the cloud—marking ten years since IBM introduced the world's first open-access quantum computer. In honor of that milestone, materials for this year's events will highlight key experiments and moments from the past decade—from early demonstrations to the large-scale 100+ qubit workloads researchers are exploring today. This is also a points-eligible activity.

[Click here](#) to learn more about how you can contribute and [register](#) for one of the Qiskit Fall Fest informational sessions we'll be holding this summer for prospective event hosts. Please note that prospective



event hosts must attend at least one informational session to get access to the event host application. Please submit all registrations for the Qiskit Fall Fest informational sessions and/or mailing list by Tuesday, 23 June.

Hope to see you all this year!

Qiskit v2.X Developer Certification exam study groups update

Our 3-month Qiskit v2.X Developer Certification exam study group initiative has come to a close, and we're thrilled with the progress and connections made by the participating Qiskit advocates. This journey has been an incredible opportunity for like-minded individuals to come together, share knowledge, and support one another in their quest for quantum computing excellence.

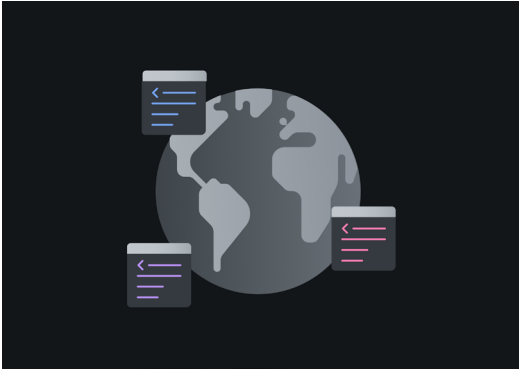
We hope that participants have not only gained valuable insights and skills but also formed lasting relationships with their fellow study group members. The initiative's goal was to provide a collaborative environment where Qiskit advocates could learn from each other, tackle challenges together, and grow as a community. We're proud to say that we've seen some amazing conversations, breakthroughs, and "aha" moments throughout the journey.

Although our program support for the study groups has ended, we encourage all participants to keep the momentum going. Here are a few key next steps to keep in mind:

- **Keep preparing:** Continue to work towards taking the Qiskit exam and achieving your certification goals.
- **Submit the form:** Submit the [closing form](#) ASAP to finalise your group's involvement, provide us with feedback on this initiative, and request a voucher.
- **Claim your points:** Don't forget to [claim your points](#) for active participation in your study group!

We believe in each and every Qiskit advocate, and we're confident that you'll crush the Qiskit exam. Remember to stay connected with your fellow study group members, continue to support one another, and celebrate each other's successes. You're part of a vibrant community that's pushing the boundaries of quantum computing, and we can't wait to see the amazing things you'll continue to achieve.

Good luck, and thank you for being an integral part of the Qiskit advocate community!



Mid-year survey

The [bi-annual feedback survey](#) is back! We're committed to providing a valuable and engaging experience for you. To help the Qiskit advocate program improve and grow, twice a year we ask for your honest thoughts on your time in the program so far.

The survey form will be open until 30 June 2026 (anywhere on Earth). This activity is points-eligible (1 point). Please only submit the survey form once at most. If you have further feedback you'd like to share, please email astri.cornish@ibm.com.

Your feedback will play a crucial role in shaping the future of the Qiskit advocate program, and we appreciate the time you take to share your insights with us.

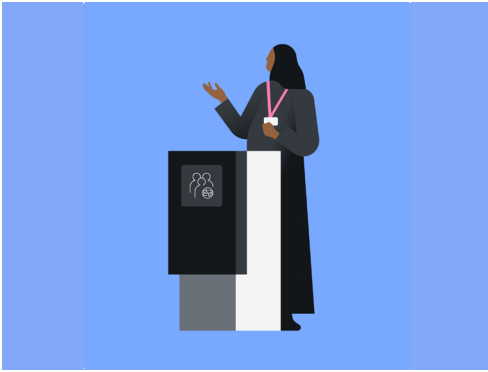
Quantum at IBM Think 2026

[IBM Think](#) is IBM's flagship annual business and technology conference. This year, the focus was on bringing the enterprise AI race into sharp focus, showing how organizations can integrate intelligence across every layer of their business—from data and automation to hybrid cloud and emerging technologies like quantum computing.

In [Jay Gambetta's](#) keynote at IBM Think 2026, [The Future of Computing is Now](#), he shared how research is delivering the future of computing with quantum. That future is already taking shape today, as evidenced by the meaningful results our clients, partners, and the quantum community are achieving.

IBM Think 2026 also featured a spotlight session, [Put Quantum to Work](#), which explored the current state of quantum computing and its potential applications. Led by Scott Crowder, Vice President of Adoption at IBM Quantum, the session brought together experts from leading organizations, including Allstate, Boeing, TCS, and Kipu Quantum. The discussion highlighted that quantum computing is no longer just a research topic, but a technology that's being actively used by organizations to solve real-world problems.

We encourage you all to spend some time watching these IBM Think 2026 sessions to hear the recent updates from this exciting time in quantum computing.



IBM Quantum updates:

- We celebrated [a decade on the cloud!](#) Ten years ago, on May 4th 2016, IBM put the first quantum computer on the cloud, moving quantum computing from a few labs to anyone with an internet connection.
- The [180 min promo](#) is still active! IBM Quantum open plan users can unlock free 180 minutes of access via our open plan able to be used anytime within 12 months of opting in once they use 20 minutes of the default 10min/month.
- A new course has been released on IBM Quantum Learning: [Use a quantum computer today](#). In the course, you'll start using a quantum computer immediately, and learn the basic principles of quantum computing along the way - perfect for beginners with a busy schedule.
- IBM recently introduced [Classroom Accounts](#), which make it easier for professors to provide students with access to real quantum systems and structured learning resources. [Request a Classroom Account](#) to bring hands-on quantum computing into your courses.

Qiskit updates:

- [Qiskit v2.4](#) has been released, making it easier to build fast, compiled tooling. New C-API features, improved Python extension support, and faster fault-tolerant compilation. Better performance without requiring changes to existing workflows.
- Watch the [Edu Day recordings](#) to learn from professors who are actively shaping the future of quantum education by integrating quantum computing into their courses, how we have made it easier than ever for educators to access hardware for their classrooms, and to explore how quantum education is evolving.
- It's been about six months since the [Quantum Advantage Tracker](#) was released! We encourage you to peruse the recent work the community has submitted to this tracker and see for yourselves the back-and-forth that is currently happening in the research community, which is shaping the future of computation.